

The Tay Boat Song

Slow Air



The Tay Boat Song: this is a song air with words by Sir Harold Boulton who also wrote “Bonny Strathyre”, “The Skye Boat Song”, and probably also the modern version of “The Bonnie Banks of Loch Lomond.” The words have his usual silky eloquence: “Nighean Ruadh your lovely hair has more glamour I declare / Than all the tresses rare from Killin to Aberfeldy...” and so on.

I first heard it sung by an English pipe major in the Duke of York’s Barracks on the King’s Road in Chelsea, in the swinging London of the early 1970s, and have played it ever since.